

ARCAN ISLAM

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EDUCATION

BEng Computer Systems Engineering | 2024 – 2027

Queen Mary University of London

Relevant Modules: Algorithms & Data Structures, Object-Oriented Programming, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, GUI, Microprocessor Systems Design, Networks & Communications, Digital Systems Design, Signals & Information, Analogue Electronic Systems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Private Tutor | Self-employed Sept 2024 – Present

- Deliver tailored academic support to GCSE and A-level students; improved grades by an average of 45% through structured feedback, scaffolded homework, and targeted revision of weak topic areas.
- Translate complex problems into clear verbal and visual explanations for diverse learners, refining communication and pedagogical skills.
- Build sustainable study habits and engagement strategies tailored to each student's learning style.

London Office Open Day | Citigroup April 2026

- Attended an exclusive open day exploring Citi's culture, business areas, and early career pathways across Banking, Markets, Services, and Wealth, including a keynote from George Murray (Director, Wealth) on Citi's global client-focused strategy.
- Worked in a team on the Services business game, advising a fictional EV company (Virgo) on its direct-to-consumer strategy; developed structured recommendations under time pressure and presented findings to peers and Citi professionals.
- Engaged with an analyst panel spanning Client, Technology, Services, and Wealth, gaining cross-functional insight into day-to-day responsibilities, career journeys, and how technology underpins financial services delivery.
- Attended a dedicated early careers session with practical guidance on applications, strengthening preparation for upcoming recruitment cycles.

Spring Insight Week | British Airways April 2026

- Completed a three-day spring insight programme across Waterside HQ and Vanguard House, exploring the BA Better World sustainability framework, Roadmap to Net Zero, and the company's core values of Caring, Excellence, and Open-mindedness.
- Toured the engineering hangar with full access to aircraft including the Airbus A380 and Boeing 777, gaining first-hand insight into large-scale maintenance operations, aerospace engineering practice, and the scale of airline operations.
- Designed a sustainable fleet strategy for 2050 in a six-person team, recommending a transition to 100% Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) and ultra-efficient aircraft; led the net zero contribution workstream and co-presented the final solution to senior BA professionals.
- Engaged with a graduate panel on career pathways and developed skills in collaborative problem-solving, technical presenting, and communicating sustainability strategy to non-specialist audiences.

Tech500 Bootcamp Participant | Microsoft, G-Research, JMAN, MAN Group July 2025

- Built a web game using GitHub Copilot and Codespaces during a vibe-coding session at Microsoft; gained career insights from female tech leaders across cloud, software engineering, and impact roles.
- Analysed market data using Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib) and participated in a trading simulation at G-Research, applying quant theory and backtesting methods while practising team-based negotiation and resource allocation.
- Delivered a data-driven consulting presentation using Python, Excel, and Power BI for a JMAN Group case study, translating analysis into client-facing recommendations.
- Investigated the impact of geopolitical events on ExxonMobil stock at the MAN Group Finance Hackathon, combining financial analysis with research synthesis.
- Engaged with professionals from Capital One, GCHQ, and Adaptive on careers in fintech, cybersecurity, and trading systems.

Taster Day Participant | Deutsche Bank Feb 2025

- Designed and presented a social media campaign for National Apprenticeship Week to senior professionals, demonstrating teamwork, research, and stakeholder communication.

- Gained insight into the Technology, Data & Innovation (TDI) role: building and maintaining software that powers ATMs and foreign exchange platforms while preserving system robustness and security.
- Shadowed an apprentice and participated in a panel discussion on career pathways into engineering and technology at Deutsche Bank.

Work Experience Participant | GCHQ / MI5 / MI6 Jan 2025

- Gained first-hand insight into cybersecurity, data analysis, and operations roles, and how technology and AI underpin modern intelligence work.
- Completed analytical puzzles and brain teasers under timed conditions to strengthen structured problem-solving and lateral thinking.
- Learned about the rigorous application and security clearance processes involved in joining UK intelligence agencies.

Insight Day Participant | Lloyds Banking Group Nov 2024

- Selected as 1 of 60 from over 2,000 applicants for an exclusive leadership and professional development programme.
- Participated in a live case study on optimising cat café profitability; proposed solutions across sales strategy, cost reduction, and digital advertising, and presented findings to senior Lloyds professionals.
- Developed self-awareness, communication, and presentation skills through interactive workshops with senior leaders.

PROJECTS

Horse Race SimulatorJava, JavaFX, OOP, Git/GitHub

- Built a real-time race simulation with a graphical interface featuring confidence boosts and fall-risk mechanics; applied data encapsulation and OOP design principles throughout.

Weather ApplicationReact, OpenWeatherMap API, Figma

- Built a responsive weather app in a team of five, fetching and displaying live weather data by location via the OpenWeatherMap API; prototyped designs in Figma and produced full requirements and evaluation documentation.

FDM Employee PortalVisual Paradigm, Requirements Engineering

- Led domain analysis, requirements elicitation, and client-facing presentations; produced functional and non-functional requirements, use case diagrams, risk assessments, and a working prototype.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Java | Python | JavaScript | TypeScript | HTML | CSS | SQL | VHDL

Technologies & Tools: React | Git | Java Swing | Linux | Figma | Visual Paradigm | Cisco Packet Tracer | GitHub Copilot

Data & Productivity: pandas | NumPy | Matplotlib | Microsoft Excel | PowerPoint | Power BI

Core Skills: Problem-solving | Teamwork | Communication | Adaptability | Strong work ethic

INTERESTS & ADDITIONAL EVENTS

Interests: Football, Gym & Calisthenics, PC Building, Fintech, Investing & Trading, Programming

Events & Insights: FactSet Insight Day · Amazon × Springpod · BAE Systems Webinar · Susquehanna Spring Day · Morgan Stanley Insight Day · Google Insight Day